

Q (a) Give a detailed account of Battle of Uhud.

[10]

Points to be covered in the answer (Divided into Paras)

- Battle of Uhad took place in 625, 3rd year of Hijra.
- Its major reasons were the revenge of Badr and to open the blockade of the trade route to Syria.
- Since the day, the Quraish faced defeat in Badr, they started a major preparation for another battle in Makkah in which they invested a huge amount.
- Pagans of Makkah came to Madinah with three thousand well equipped men. They stayed into a ground in front of the Uhad Mountain.
- The Prophet (PBUH) was in favor of defending and staying in the city but the young boys insisted on going out and fight. The Prophet (saw) took one thousand men with him.
- On his way to Uhad, three hundred hypocrites led by Abdullah ibn Ubayy deserted the army. He left with his 300 men. Muslims were only seven hundred in front of three thousand well equipped Quraish.
- The Prophet (PBUH) placed 50 archers under the command of Abdullah bin Jubair to defend a pass which was a dangerous position can be used to attack Muslims from the back.
- The battle began and Allah fulfilled His promise and the Muslims almost won the battle. Pagans started running back to Makkah.
- When Muslims saw this defeat, they started looting spoils of war without asking the Prophet (PBUH). When the archers saw this, they left the pass and joined the other Muslims and left the pass unguarded.
- Khalid Bin Walid was a capable general of Quraish. He saw the opening without any protection. He took his 200 cavalry men and attacked from behind. Muslims were not ready for this attack and it caused panic everywhere.
- In this panic, Wahshi slave of Hinda got a chance and killed Hamza (RA), the uncle of the Prophet (PBUH).
- The Prophet (PBUH) was also injured and lost his tooth. Mus'ab bin Umair (RA) got martyred he was so much identical to Holy Prophet (PBUH). Someone spread a rumor that Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) has been killed. That caused more mishap and depression among Muslim army resulting huge casualties on Muslim side.
- This is strange that the Quraish had won but they decided to go back to Makkah and not attacking Madinah.
- Abu Sufyan, the leader of the Quraish challenged the Muslims to have another fight next year in Badr. The Prophet (PBUH) was injured and the Muslim army was demoralized, yet Muslim army chased Makkans.
- Apparently, the Quraish won the battle but in reality, they could not achieve both of their targets. Neither they killed the Prophet nor could they open the trade route. It meant that the next battle was inevitable.
- From this battle, Muslims got the lesson that they must not disobey the Prophet (PBUH) and the Muslim commander.
- The Muslims lost the battle due to their greed. The pagans did not capture Madinah and went back to Makkah.